

c) That mathematics is not easy or logic is difficult.

Soln: Conclusion: $\neg P \vee P$

Steps

Reason

1. $P \vee \neg P$

Premise

2. $P \rightarrow \neg P$

Premise

3. $\neg P \vee \neg P$

Conditional-disjunction equivalence on 2

Clause C1: $P \vee \neg P$

C2: $\neg P \vee \neg P$

C3:

$\neg(\neg P \vee P) \equiv \neg(\neg P) \wedge \neg P$ (De Morgan's Law) $\equiv P \wedge \neg P$ (Double-negation Law)

C3: P C4: $\neg P$

By Resolution on C3, C2 we get C5: $\neg P$

By Resolution on C4, C5 we get C6: $\neg P$

By Resolution on C6, C1 we get C7: $\neg P$

We cannot reach a contradiction from C7 and other clauses

$\therefore$ The conclusion is not valid.

d) That logic is not difficult or mathematics is not easy.

Soln: Conclusion: $\neg P \vee \neg R$

Steps

Reason

1. $P \vee \neg P$

Premise

2. $P \rightarrow \neg P$

Premise

3. $\neg P \vee \neg P$

Conditional-disjunction equivalence on 2

4. $\neg P \vee \neg R$

Commutative law on 3

e) That if not many students like logic, then either mathematics is not easy or logic is not difficult.

Soln: Conclusion: $\neg Q \rightarrow (\neg R \vee \neg P)$